

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8
 ♥ J 10 5 3
 ♦ K 9 2
 ♣ J 10 3

♠ 7 4 3

♥ 9 7 6

♦ 8 5

♣ A K 6 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 9 5 2

♥ Q 8 4

♦ J 10 6 4

♣ 9

♠ A 6

♥ A K 2

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ Q 8 7 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	1NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♠ 5			

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠ 5.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=5 Total = 9

Wow! The winners add up to 9 already. We have assumed that ♣s will split no worse than 3-1, which is exactly how they do split. Is there any other pitfall you might need to worry about?

You win the ♠ A.

Just one minor problem. The ♣s will block if you are not careful! So you win the ♠ A, then play dummy's ♣Q. Next you play dummy's ♣8 to your ♣K. Then your ♣A on which you put dummy's ♣7. Aha! Now when you play your ♣6 you will be able to keep the lead.

If the ♣5 and ♣6 were swapped around the contract could not be made.

As they are, though, the contract is cold. But only if you are a good bridge player!

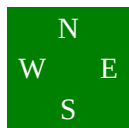
Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q 9
 ♥ A 7 5 3
 ♦ A J 6 4
 ♣ A K

♠ 6 3
 ♥ J 10 9 8 2
 ♦ Q 10 2
 ♣ 9 7 4



♠ K J 4
 ♥ Q 6
 ♦ 8 5 3
 ♣ J 10 6 3 2

♠ 10 8 7 5 2
 ♥ K 4
 ♦ K 9 7
 ♣ Q 8 5

West	North	East	South
2 ♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♠ 5			

to your ♠ J. Play your ♣ J (and another one if necessary) to establish the ♣ suit. Win whatever red card they play next with dummy's Ace. Play the ♠ Q to your ♠ K and cash your established ! C(s). Dummy's other red Ace will be your ninth trick.

The more you make a point of looking for entries the easier they are to find.

You'd have to be very careless to miss this one.

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠ 5.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

Needing two winners you will naturally consider your 5-card ♣ suit. After unblocking the ♣ A K you will need two entries to your hand; one to lead the ♣ J and drive out the ♣ Q, then a second to enjoy your good ♣ s.

The ♠ suit will provide one entry easily, but should you depend on the ♥ Q for the second entry?

No, for two reasons. Firstly the ♥ Q only gives you a 50% chance of being an entry. But more importantly, you already have your two sure entries in ♠ s. As long as you take the first trick with dummy's ♠ A both your ♠ K and ♠ J can be entries.

Win the ♠ A. Play off dummy's ♣ A K. Lead the ♠ 9

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 5
 ♥ K 7 2
 ♦ 8 6 4
 ♣ Q 10 7 5

♠ 10 7

♥ 8 6 5

♦ K Q 7 3

♣ J 9 4 2



♠ K J 9 2
 ♥ Q 10 9 3
 ♦ 10 9 5 2
 ♣ 6

♠ A 6 4 3

♥ A J 4

♦ A J

♣ A K 8 3

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♣5			

You are sure to have a ♣ entry to dummy's ♦s, and you will still get three ♣ tricks, just a different three.

Suppose the opening lead had been a ♦ rather than a ♣.

You probably would have played the hand the same way you just did, unblock ♦s, then play ♣ A K and a low ♣ toward the ♣ J 9 trying to get a ♣ entry to dummy.

It is only because the ♣ opening lead gives you the chance for a Cheap-Trick that you are tempted to go wrong.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♣5. You play low from dummy and East plays the ♣6.

Winners: ♠ = 1 ♥ = 1 ♦ = 4? ♣ = 3 Total = 9

Although you have 4 ♦ winners, getting to the last couple might not be so easy. You can make 3 ♦ tricks simply by winning your ♦ A, then overtaking your ♦ J with dummy's ♦ Q. But you need that fourth ♦ winner. Can you get it?

Sure you can, by creating an entry in ♣s. It is likely from the opening lead, (and East's play of a small card), that West has led from ♣ Q 10 7 5. If you win the first trick cheaply then you will still make your ♣ A K for three ♣ tricks in all.

So don't win cheaply, win the first trick with the ♣ A. Then unblock your ♦ A J. Next play ♣ K. (on which East discards), and a small ♣ toward dummy's ♣ J 9.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 6
 ♥ K 5 2
 ♦ K Q J 5
 ♣ A Q J 4

♠ Q J 10 9 5

♥ A 9 3

♦ 9 8 3

♣ 10 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 3

♥ J 7 4

♦ A 6 4 2

♣ 7 6 5 3

♠ K 7 4 2

♥ Q 10 8 6

♦ 10 7

♣ K 9 2

West	North	East	South
2NT	Pass	Pass	Pass
All Pass		3NT	
3NT by West			
Lead: ♠ Q			

West is to play 3NT. North leads the ♠Q. South plays the ♠K, then the ♠2 when you hold up.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=4 ♣=1 Total = 6

You are going to have to be pretty lucky to make this contract. You cannot touch the ♥ suit because a defender would take the ♥A and it would start raining ♠s.

So you will have to get 3 extra ♣ winners, which means the ♣ finesse absolutely MUST work.

In addition to lucky, you are going to have to be pretty good, too. You will surely have to finesse the ♣s at least twice; that means you need two dummy entries. Can you find them?

You won the second ♠.

Maybe in ♦s. Play the ♦K, then ♦Q, watching the defender's cards carefully. When both follow twice you know there is only a single ♦ left out, so you play the ♦J to dummy's ♦A. Now take the ♣ finesse. It works! Next play your ♦5 to dummy's ♦6 and take another ♣ finesse. Both defenders follow so your ♣s are good.

If the ♦s split 4-1 you would have found out when you cashed the ♦ K Q.

Then your chance of success goes way down. You would have to find South with the doubleton ♣K.